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NORTHFIELD HEALTH

Renal Function Safety Thresholds for Electrolyte Replacement

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Section 1. Purpose

This reference lists the laboratory thresholds that must be met before electrolyte infusions are started under a standing order.

Section 2.3 Timing of the sample

A serum creatinine used to clear a standing-order infusion must be drawn within the preceding 4 hours and documented in the electronic medical record.

Section 2.4 Creatinine threshold

Serum creatinine above 1.8 mg/dL invalidates standing-order electrolyte infusion clearance without direct nephrology or attending physician consultation.

Section 2.5 Urine output

If acute anuria or oliguria (below 0.5 mL/kg/hr over 2 consecutive hours) is observed, immediate bedside consultation with an attending physician is mandatory before an infusion is primed.

Section 3. Documentation

The creatinine value, the sample time and the name of the clinician who verified it must be recorded before the infusion starts.